

TROUBLING BATTERS LEFT, RIGHT AND CENTRE

With the 38-year-old R. Ashwin announcing his retirement from international cricket, here are some **standout numbers** from his illustrious career.

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Few players have analysed cricket as deeply as R. Ashwin. Even fewer have dared to execute their ideas on the field with the same audacity. For over a decade, Ashwin strode the globe as one of the sport's premier spin exponents, playing a pivotal role in establishing India's dominance in Test cricket, particularly on home soil. With the 38-year-old announcing his retirement from international cricket, here are some standout numbers from his illustrious career:

Asymmetry

No bowler troubled left-handed batters quite like Ashwin. The off-spinner had a remarkable edge against southpaws, claiming more left-handed wickets than anyone else in international cricket.

Ashwin's Test record came tantalisingly close to a perfectly symmetrical left-right dismissal count – 269

right-handers and 268 left-handers. The balance was tipped when he dismissed Mitchell Marsh for his final Test wicket during the pink-ball match in Adelaide.

Three of his most frequent victims were left-handers. England's Test captain Ben Stokes tops the list, having been dismissed 17 times by Ashwin across formats. Retired Australian opener David Warner and Sri Lanka's Lahiru Thirimanne follow, with 14 dismissals each.

The Carrom Flicker

In his autobiography, *I Have the Streets: A Kutti Cricket Story*, Ashwin revealed that the carrom ball – a

R. ASHWIN BOWLING VARIATIONS IN TESTS

Variation

OFF BREAK

Balls	Wickets	Average	Strike rate
25580	461	26.66	55.4

QUICKER BALL

Balls	Wickets	Average	Strike rate
358	9	13.22	39.7

TOP SPINNER

Balls	Wickets	Average	Strike rate
128	4	8.75	32

CARROM BALL

Balls	Wickets	Average	Strike rate
578	34	6.58	17

ARM BALL

Balls	Wickets	Average	Strike rate
379	24	6	15.7

OTHERS

Balls	Wickets	Average	Strike rate
223	5	15.4	44.6